

STATEMENT

BY

THE SECRETARY FOR TRADE AND INDUSTRY

MRS. CHRISTINA ZAKEYO

ON

THE COMMENCENMENT OF THE AWARENESS ACTIVITIES AND ENFORCEMENT ACTION OF THE BUSINESS LICENSING (DEPLOYMENT AND USAGE OF ELECTRONIC PAYMENT CHANNELS) REGULATIONS

BINGU INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCE CENTRE

LILONGWE

16th AUGUST, 2022

The Governor of the Reserve Bank of Malawi,

Directors and Members of Staff of the Reserve Bank of Malawi

The Director of Trade and all senior Government Officials present

Distinguished Participants

Ladies and Gentlemen

My role this afternoon is to request the guest of honour to officially launch this event. However, before I do so, allow me to say a few words. Let me preface my Statement by expressing my pleasure and delight for the privilege and honour of being with you today as we start the Awareness Activities and Enforcement Action of the **Business Licensing (Deployment and Usage of Electronic Payment Channels) Regulations.** I would like to applaud you, Governor and your team from the Reserve Bank of Malawi who have worked tirelessly to develop the e-payment system.

The impact that the sytem will have on the services offered especially by Small and Medium Enterprises (SMEs) is far reaching. It is our belief as Ministry of Trade and Industry that through the deployment and usage of different electronic payment systems, transactions between traders will now be seamless. I am particularly happy with the cross section of participants attending this launch event and it is our wish that everyone present here will

carry the message and share with fellow business persons so that the e-Payment system benefits all enterprises operating businesses within Malawi and beyond.

Distinguished Ladies and Gentlemen

Although electronic Payments are becoming a seamless, fast and simple way for making payments, many businesses have not yet accepted the system because they do not know about it.

As most of you may be aware, one of the enablers for the Mw **2063, Malawi Implementation Plan** that has been set aside for the development of **Malawi** in the next ten year is **Digitalisation**. This entails establishing new systems of enhancing technology within our economy by easing the way customers transact with businesses or service providers in the country. By going cashless, people will be able to purchase a number of items without having the need to carry large sums of money.

Therefore, this project augurs well with the aspirations of the Government agenda including the establishment of the National Electronic Single Window system that the Ministry together with other Government agencies is championing and which will integrate all regulatory functions through a single electronic platform for import, export and transit trade. The e-Payment system will also complement the automated trade licensing system currently being finalised by the Ministry. As such, I would like to

urge all entrepreneurs to accept and adopt the e-payment system even as this is being rolled out. It is said and I quote: “An early bird catches the worm”. So let us be the champions and let others follow!

Distinguished Ladies and Gentlemen

Someone might be asking Why use E-Payment Systems?

The reasons are many. Some are:-

a) It promotes fast transactions between consumers and traders since money can be transferred within minutes.
b) It eases transactions made in Malawi for goods abroad. With the use of these E-Payment Systems, people can purchase goods online without having to go through long processes.
c) Low Risk of theft since cash is sent directly to the receiving account and not kept within the premises of the shop.
d) It is Contactless hence preventing the risk of contracting COVID 19.

Distinguished Ladies and Gentlemen

I sincerely appeal to all participants present here today to seriously give your honest input to all the different payment service providers available here. All concerns that needed to be addressed can be answered today so as to help all players in the sector to adopt the use of electronic payment systems.

With these remarks, it is now my singular honour and privilege to request the guest of honour to make his statement and officially launch the Awareness activities and enforcement action of the e-payment system.

Thank you very much for listening.